skin, is a perfect curative for burns. And so on through the whole field of morbid irritations.

Diseases are found practically to consist of local or general conditions, or both; and however similar their names, and even their symptoms or functional manifestations, or indeed their organic lesions, may differ widely in different persons, or in the same person at different times and stages.

In general we may say the difference may be commonly found connected on the one hand with irritative, and on the other hand with paretic states. Locally, and in previously healthy persons, the irritative state predominates and calls for a specific method,—that of functional regulation, first of all, with concomitant nutritive influences,—in electric treatment.

In the sphere of the general system, in very many cases, the same is true; yet, in other cases and after exhausting or relaxing influences, local or general, the paretic state predominates, and calls for a different application of the same currents,—that of nutritive regulation with concomitant functional effect.

The mere presence of electricity has some influence in both these ways, but the specific stimulating functional influence prevails in the DIRECT, or downward running currents; the sedative and nutritive in the REVERSE, or upward running currents; counting the positive pole as that which gives the flow, and the negative as that which receives it in the molecular movement which completes the electric arc.

In the vast majority of cases the downward currents are to be chosen. These may run on the track of the nerves or athwart them, according as a ner-